

Chi Danh Dao (Dan)

Contact Information

Institution: Queen's University
Department: Department of Economics
Location: Kingston, ON, Canada
Phone: +1 343-989-6869
Email: 21cdd3@queens.ca

Immigration Status: Canadian Citizen

Education

- **Queen's University, Canada**
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics , 2021–Present
- **University of New Brunswick, Canada**
M.A. in Economics, 2019–2021
- **Tan Tao University, Vietnam**
B.Sc. in Finance and Accounting, Cum Laude, 2011–2015

Research Projects

- *Profiles of Debt: Revolving Behavior and Financial Well-Being*

Abstract: By Q2 2024, Canadian credit card debt exceeded CAD 122 billion, raising concerns about financial vulnerability. This paper uses microdata from the Bank of Canada's Digital Wallet and Payment Trends Survey to examine the characteristics of credit card users. We find that debt-carrying cardholders (i.e., *Revolvers*) do not exhibit greater financial stress or lower savings than non-revolvers. Education and liquidity constraints, rather than income, are key determinants of revolving behavior, indicating that credit card debt often reflects financial management rather than distress. Moreover, many *Revolvers* hold high-interest reward cards misaligned with their borrowing patterns, creating an avoidable annual debt burden of roughly CAD 500 million, primarily affecting middle-income, less-educated households. These findings suggest that credit card debt in Canada largely functions as a liquidity management tool rather than a signal of financial fragility.

- *Rewards, Credit Access, and Inequality in the Credit Card Market (Job Market Paper)*

Abstract: Credit card use in Canada has raised concerns that rewards programs may exacerbate economic inequalities, with high-income, financially sophisticated consumers capturing disproportionate benefits. Existing studies, however, focus on nominal rewards and treat credit cards only as payment instruments, overlooking both the diminishing marginal utility of rewards and the value of credit access for revolving households. Using microdata from the *Digital Wallet and Payment Trends Survey*, this paper estimates a discrete choice model to quantify the consumer surplus associated with credit card use, capturing heterogeneity in preferences, rewards structures, and spending patterns. The analysis highlights how welfare gains from credit card rewards and credit access differ across demographic groups, providing a nuanced measure of the distributional effects of credit cards and informing policy discussions on inequality and household financial resilience.

Publication

- **Brodeur, Abel, et al.** (2026). “Reproducibility and Robustness of Economics and Political Science Research.” *Nature*, 652, 151–156. doi:10.1038/s41586-026-10251-x. *Contributor as a member of the replication team.*

Work Experience

- PhD Internship, Currency Department, Bank of Canada, 2024

Presentations

- Canadian Economics Association Conference, 2021, 2024
- Bank of Canada, 2024

Awards, Honors and Scholarships

- John Deutsch Institute for the Study of Economic Policy Student Fellowship, 2026
- Harold Burke Memorial Scholarship, 2020
- Faculty of Arts Graduate Assistantship (AGA), University of New Brunswick, 2019–2021
- Full Scholarship, Tan Tao University, 2011–2015

Technical Skills: Python, R, GAMS, Matlab, C

Personal Information

Languages: English, Vietnamese

References

Dr. Oleksandr Shcherbakov

Associate Director
Bank of Canada
AShcherbakov@bank-banque-canada.ca

Dr. Robert Clark

Professor, Department of Economics
University of Toronto
rob.clark@utoronto.ca

Dr. Nahim Bin Zahur

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
Queens’ University
nahim.zahur@queensu.ca